04-28 第一篇

The Story of Salt: More Than Just a Seasoning

Today we add salt to our food without thinking. But thousands of years ago, salt was one of the most valuable things in the world. [1] It was used to keep food from going bad, and in some places it was even used as money. The ancient Romans sometimes paid their soldiers in salt—and that is where the English word "salary（薪金）" comes from. Without salt, many civilizations（文明） could not have grown or traded as they did.

Salt can be found in different ways. In warm climates, people learned to get salt by evaporating（蒸发） seawater in shallow pools. [2] When the water dried up, the salt was left behind and could be collected. In colder regions, people dug mines to find salt buried in the earth. In China, salt production has a history of more than four thousand years. Different cultures found their own ways to get salt, depending on where they lived and what resources they had.

During the Middle Ages in Europe, salt became even more important. [3] It was needed to preserve meat and fish so that people could eat them in winter when fresh food was scarce（稀缺的）. Salt was taxed heavily, and some rulers controlled the salt trade to earn money. In some countries, carrying salt across borders without paying tax was against the law. This shows how powerful and valuable salt was in daily life and in politics.

In the modern age, we produce far more salt than we need. [4] Most of the salt we use today goes to industry—for making paper, soap, and many chemicals. We still use it to preserve some foods, but refrigeration（冷藏） has made that less necessary. Yet salt remains essential. Our bodies need a small amount of salt to work properly. Too much salt, however, can harm our health, so doctors advise us to use it in moderation（适度）.

[5] From ancient treasure to everyday seasoning, salt has played a huge role in human history. It has shaped trade, wars, and cultures. Next time you pick up the salt shaker at the dinner table, remember that you are holding something that once changed the world.

选项

A. In other words, people in different places developed different methods to obtain salt based on their environment. B. That is why salt was so important to both everyday life and the economy in those times. C. In short, salt is far more than a simple flavor; it has been central to human progress. D. Before refrigerators were invented, salt was one of the best ways to make food last longer. E. Today, however, salt is used for much more

than cooking and preserving food. F. Salt roads were built to carry this valuable good from places where it was mined to cities and markets.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] D [2] A [3] B [4] E [5] C

深度解析

- **[1] D**：
  - **线索**：引出盐在古代的用途与价值。空前说明"salt was one of the most valuable things...thousands of years ago"，空后具体举例"It was used to keep food from going bad...used as money...Romans paid soldiers in salt...'salary' comes from"。D选项"Before refrigerators were invented, salt was one of the best ways to make food last longer"（在冰箱发明之前，盐是让食物保存更久的最佳方法之一）与空后"used to keep food from going bad"精准对应，自然引出下文对保存、交易、薪金来源的展开，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] A**：
  - **线索**：不同地区获取盐的方式总结。空前详述"evaporating seawater in shallow pools...water dried up, salt left behind...In colder regions, dug mines...In China, salt production has a history of more than four thousand years"，空后说明"Different cultures found their own ways...depending on where they lived and what resources they had"。A选项"In other words, people in different places developed different methods to obtain salt based on their environment"（换言之，不同地区的人们根据环境发展出不同的取盐方法）中"In other words"对上文列举进行概括，"different places...different methods...based on their environment"与空后"Different cultures...depending on where they lived"完美呼应，逻辑紧密。
- **[3] B**：
  - **线索**：中世纪欧洲盐的重要性与政治经济意义。空前描述"During the Middle Ages...salt became even more important...needed to preserve meat and fish...eat in winter when fresh food scarce...salt was taxed heavily...rulers controlled the salt trade"，空后说明"In some countries, carrying salt across borders without paying tax was against the law...shows how powerful and valuable salt was"。B选项"That is why salt was so important to both everyday life and the economy in those times"（因此盐在那时对日常生活和经济都至关重要）中"That is why"承接空前"needed to preserve...taxed heavily...controlled"，"everyday life and the economy"与空后"powerful and valuable...in daily life and in politics"对应，衔接自然。

- [4] E：
  - **线索**：现代盐的新用途与角色变化。空前说明"In the modern age, we produce far more salt than we need"，空后列举"Most of the salt we use today goes to industry—making paper, soap, chemicals...still use to preserve...refrigeration has made that less necessary...bodies need a small amount...Too much can harm health"。E选项"Today, however, salt is used for much more than cooking and preserving food"（然而今天，盐的用途远不止烹饪和保存食物）中"Today, however"承接古今对比，"much more than cooking and preserving"与空后"goes to industry"及"refrigeration has made that less necessary"精准呼应，衔接得当。
- [5] C：
  - **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后列举"From ancient treasure to everyday seasoning...played a huge role...shaped trade, wars, cultures...holding something that once changed the world"。C选项"In short, salt is far more than a simple flavor; it has been central to human progress"（简言之，盐远非简单的调味品；它一直是人类进步的核心）用"In short"总结全文，"far more than a simple flavor...central to human progress"与空后"huge role...shaped trade, wars, cultures...changed the world"形成升华，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. Salt roads were built to carry this valuable good from places where it was mined to cities and markets.**：涉及盐的运输与贸易，易被误填[3]。但F聚焦"盐路"这一具体设施，而空[3]前后文讨论的是盐的保存功能、税收、法律控制，未提及道路或运输；且F为事实陈述，缺少逻辑衔接词。若填入[3]，会打断"preserve—taxed—controlled—law"的递进逻辑。F属"主题相关但内容与上下文不匹配"型干扰。